

Business Drivers and Pain Points in TOGAF

A TOGAF-aligned explanation of how Business Drivers, Pain Points, stakeholder concerns, goals, objectives, requirements, and architecture relate to one another.

Business Driver

Definition: A Business Driver is a condition, force, pressure, opportunity, or need that motivates the organization to change.

It answers the question:

"Why does the organization need to do something?"

Type	Example Business Driver
Cost	Reduce IT operating costs
Regulatory	Meet new regulatory requirements
Customer	Improve customer experience
Operational	Increase operational efficiency
Technology	Modernize aging technology
Risk	Reduce cybersecurity exposure
Growth	Support expansion into new markets
Strategy	Enable an enterprise AI strategy
Workforce	Improve employee productivity
Data	Improve access to trusted enterprise information

A good business driver is expressed at the business level rather than as a specific technology solution.

Good: Improve employee access to authoritative corporate policy information.

Less appropriate as a driver: Implement Azure AI Search and GPT-5.

Pain Point

Definition: A Pain Point describes a current problem, deficiency, obstacle, dissatisfaction, inefficiency, or risk experienced by the organization or its stakeholders.

It answers the question:

"What is wrong with the current situation?"

TOGAF does not require an artifact literally named a Pain Point Catalog. In practice, pain points are commonly captured through related TOGAF concepts such as stakeholder concerns, problems, issues, gaps, constraints, and business requirements.

Pain Point	What is happening today
Policy information is difficult to locate	Employees search several repositories manually
Answers take too long	Employees must read lengthy policy documents
Information is inconsistent	Different employees interpret policies differently
Subject-matter experts are overloaded	SMEs repeatedly answer the same policy questions
Search quality is poor	Keyword searches fail to understand user intent
Compliance risk exists	Employees may unknowingly use obsolete policies

Pain Point = problem with the current state

Business Driver = reason the organization is motivated to change the current state

How the TOGAF Concepts Fit Together

Stakeholder Concern / Pain Point -> Business Driver -> Business Goal -> Business Objective -> Requirement -> Architecture

TOGAF-related concept	Corporate Policy AI Assistant example
Stakeholder	Corporate employee
Concern / Pain Point	Employees have difficulty finding relevant policy information
Business Driver	Improve access to authoritative corporate policy information
Business Goal	Provide employees with faster and more reliable access to corporate policies
Business Objective	Reduce average policy-information retrieval time by 60%
Business Requirement	Employees must be able to submit natural-language policy questions
Architecture Requirement	The solution must retrieve relevant policy content from the approved corporate policy repository
Solution	Corporate Policy AI Assistant using RAG, Azure AI Search, an embeddings model, and an LLM

Incident Management Example

Pain Point / Stakeholder Concern: Incident managers spend excessive time locating and interpreting incident-management policies.

Business Driver: Improve the speed and consistency of IT incident management decision-making.

Business Goal: Provide incident managers rapid access to authoritative incident-management policies.

Business Objective: Reduce policy lookup time from an average of 20 minutes to less than 5 minutes.

Requirement: The Corporate Policy AI Assistant shall retrieve and present relevant incident-management policy information in response to natural-language questions.

Progression: Problem -> Motivation -> Desired outcome -> Measurable target -> Required capability

A Simple Classification Rule

Question	Classification
"What problem do we have?"	Pain Point
"Why must the organization act?"	Business Driver

Recommended TOGAF-Oriented Structure

1. Stakeholders and Concerns
2. Current-State Pain Points
3. Business Drivers
4. Business Goals
5. Business Objectives / KPIs
6. Business Requirements
7. Architecture Requirements

This structure creates traceability from why the initiative exists through what the architecture must provide, and helps connect the Problem Statement, Business Drivers, Objectives, KPIs, Use Cases, and architecture diagrams.

Note: This document is a practical TOGAF-aligned explanation. Organizations may tailor terminology and artifacts to their architecture governance practices.